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In Loving Memory of Dorothy Poppitz

Council Vacancy

The city council filled the council seat vacancy by appointment of Mary Williamson. Before taking her seat on the council, she took the Office of Oath. Welcome aboard to the city council.

Fire Department

The Fire Department has elected Scott King as the Fire Chief. Mr King briefed the council on his experience with other Fire Departments and an account of his background. Mr King has been with the Carver Department for five years. The council inquired about the election. Motion was made and carried with all ayes appointing Scott King as Carver Fire Department Chief. During the day a plan is in place for necessary personnel, as well as mutual aid.

The council reviewed the monthly and yearly reports with the Fire Chief. The council reviewed the department's request for a Pumper/ Tanker truck. The work completed by the purchasing committee was reviewed. This truck was needed to maintain ISO ratings. Motion was made and carried with all ayes authorizing purchase of the 1989 pumper/tanker truck inclusive of hose and pails of foam.

The council stated that it would only be appropriate to honor and commend service of Jerry Dauwalter as Fire Chief. The Fire Department's Annual Meeting was scheduled for January 26th and plans were being made. The council would like to be present at the meeting.

Third Street

The council discussed the existing spring along Third Street West, which has been causing drainage issues west of Jorgenson. Various measures have been attempted addressing the issue to no avail. The springs continue to run causing icing issues. Drain tile placement appeared to be the most cost efficient resolution. Storm sewer and drain tiles are inevitable in the future. Cost options were reviewed. The issue of the bridges was also reviewed with the reminder that they in the historical district.

"It is a capital mistake to theorize before one has data. Insensibly one begins to twist facts to suite theories, instead of theories to suit facts."

- Sir Anthony Conan Doyle

Carver Ridge

The council was told that the street and utility improvements are completed for both plats in the first and second phases of Carver Ridge along with the developer completing draft for identified street and utility punch list items. A two year maintenance bond and record plan on the improvements is complete. There are two erosion control and pond items remaining, the removal and maintenance through winter and spring of the final silt fence areas and possible removal of material of pond. This would be verified and completed in spring. The engineer recommended acceptance of the street and utility improvements for the developments. Motion was made and carried with all ayes accepting the street and utility improvements upon payment reducing requirement to be paid and maintaining existing escrow upon final completion in the spring of 2006.

River Bluffs Estates

The council reviewed memo and pictures of the pond restoration efforts at River Bluffs Estates development. The council inquired about the sediment in the pond and tests. Comment was made that the slope should be decreased so that the problems would not persist. The engineer is to monitor the progress of the project. The council discussed the issue being brought before the council and delays that could incur as a result of said request. It was one council member's opinion that the developer complete a Watershed Management Plan. Motion was made and carried with four ayes and one nay that any deviation from the slope and erosion plan be submitted to the council.

Sanitation Collection

The city attorney had met with sanitation contractors upon agreement to a proposed Memo of Understanding. This issue was tabled.

Discussions had been occurring between the sanitation collection personnel and the attorney with the result of signatures being obtained for a suggested Memorandum of Understanding. The attorney explained that if the city really preferred the avenue of only allowing one company; it would be a long hard journey to pursue The attorney's recommendation was to accept the Memorandum. Motion was made and carried with all ayes approving and agreeing to the Memorandum of Understanding with the sanitation collection businesses.

Did You Know...

...that the winter of 1867-1877 was warm and snow-fre in Carver, following an extremely dry summer and heavy rainfall in the fall.

Miscellaneous

The council acknowledged the response received from Hans Hagen addressing the issue of Carver Bluffs West Park Fee.

BASEBALL IS BACK.....Youth Baseball is returning to Carver. Registration begins in February. Registration forms will be available at City Hall in February. Want more information, call 952) 448-5353.

The City Planner, Cindy Olness addressed the council updating them on the Metropolitan Council's response regarding the System Statement revision. Letter had been forwarded to the Dahlgren Township Board and a new System Statement had been issued. It was the city attorney's opinion that the issue was getting worked out. The attorney will be attending the scheduled hearing. He reviewed with the council some of the changes that the Metropolitan Council had agreed to.

The council discussed the need for a volunteer to attend the Local Board of Review Training Session. The council had been informed of the '03State Law requirement that the Local Board of Appeal and Equalization cannot be held unless, at least one member attended an appeals and equalization course developed or approved by the MN Commissioner of Revenue. The individual who filled this requirement had resigned requiring a volunteer to attend this course. Council member Williamson stepped forward to fulfill the requirement.

Preliminary discussions have occurred with school officials regarding a proposed new school on County Road #40.

Carver's Women's Business Group

Here's some additional information about the 3rd Annual Taste of Christmas and Home Tour event. The event was an obvious success again. The Church by the River rocked as "Chuck and Friends" entertained guests with a variety of music. Some songs were written by local resident Chuck Sells - what a talent! Also, thanks to all who participated in the home tour and were willing to let perfect strangers enjoy their holiday decorating. Funds were raised and will soon be donated back to the Depot Park project.
The Carver Women's Business Club meets on the first Tuesday of Each month at 12:00 noon at the Church by the River. Anyone is welcome to join, visit, discuss, or just bring food and eat. The meetings are designed for entrepreneurs to network and inspire others in their business ventures. For additional information call Suzanne at 952-292-8479.

Municipal Utilities

The Public Utilities Superintendent's report for the Water and Wastewater Departments was reviewed by the council. The city had used more water this year than the previous year. The WasteWater Treatment had also increased considerably over the past several years as well the council was told. The superintendent requisitioned for a trailer to haul equipment for the utilities departments since the public works department equipment is not always readily available when needed. Motion was made and carried approving the purchase of a trailer for the Municipal Utilities departments.

The city engineer informed the council that Centex Homes submitted a request petitioning the city to prepare feasibility report Extending the water main from the east end of their plat to Mt Hope Road along Highway #212. The council was asked to recall the report prepared in 2005 involving the Northwest Service Area Water main Extension Improvement on the water main loop from the Lylewood Glen Plat along County Road # 147 to Highway #212 and then to Mt Hope Road. At that time the two developers proposed to complete the loop as part of their development improvements. The council was reminded that the loop required completion in the spring of 2006 to meet water service needs for the proposed occupancy in the Centex plat. Also that the schedule on the Booster Station project is to correspond with the completed water main loop.

The council was told that it is still the intent of the two developers to install the water main, however dependent upon the final approvals the council has been petitioned to prepare the feasibility report. It is the engineer's intention to update the feasibility report for the area to the east of the Spring Creek Plat. The engineer proceeded to inform the council that if the project proceeds as a city project under Chapter #429, then a public hearing will be necessary to review the report with adjacent property owners. The cost of this report was discussed. Motion was made and carried with all four ayes and one nay approving the resolution "declaring adequacy of petition and ordering preparation of report" with contingencies.

The city had been petitioned for revising feasibility report for the northwest service area water main extension improvements from the east of Centex plat to Mount Hope Road along Highway #212. Authorization had been granted previously. Options were discussed inclusive of installing a new water main in the Highway #212 right-of-way or install a new water main in conjunction with the development of the Grimm and Butler properties. The waterman placement would remain open at this time. Motion was made and carried with all ayes scheduling a Public Hearing for March to determine where the water main should be installed in the Glen at Spring Creek area.

Did You Know...

...that on Thursday night, May 13th, 1880 burglars broke into the dry goods and grocery store of Bristle and Bengtson in Carver and blew open the safe just as the midnight train passed through to cover the noise of the explosion. They escaped with $700 in cash and notes, with at least one of the burglars being captured later.

Recreational Planning

Ms Kristy Mock was at the Park and Recreation Board meeting to share a presentation on Recreational Planning and objectives for 2006. The discussion included registrations, choosing leagues, scheduling, fees and advertising. The board discussed the issues of coaches, uniforms , equipment, game schedules, posting on the website and deadlines. Procedures and allocations, along with policies were reviewed. Further discussion involved rental payment policies and contract forms.

The Park and Recreation Board needs to channel their efforts to the future for parks, trails and partnering with other organizations similar to the Fish and Wildlife, District #112 and developers, as well as business owners. Connection of existing and future trail systems were reviewed.

Discussions were also held on proposing ideas for a memorial to Paul Reimer for all the projects he was involved in with the city. Notation was made that the Black Sox and Carver Youth Baseball/Softball Youth Association would like to participate in the proposal.

Certified Local Government Grant

The Heritage Preservation Commission requested funding from the city to match the Certified Local Government grant application for a historic resource survey in the Historic District. This type of survey has not been completed since the original National Historic District nomination. Recommended guidelines suggest updates every five years or so. A consultant would be required to meet with the Secretary of Interior's standards for a preservation professional to be hired. Suggestion was submitted that this survey also be planned for the Comprehensive Plan at some point. Motion was made and carried granting the Heritage Preservation Commission request for matching fund if the grant were to be awarded.

Bed and Breakfast Proposal

Prospective purchasers attended the council meeting proposing plans for an owner/ occupied Bed and Breakfast for the Funk House and then utilize the Griffin House as specialty retail location. This proposed rezoning is consistent with the guidance of Town Center in the Comprehensive Plan. Current owners' bills owed the city were discussed. Motion was made and carried with all ayes approving the resolution to rezone from residential to Central Business District for two properties contingent on payment of bills paid by current owners. Motion was made and carried with all ayes adopting ordinance rezoning said properties to Central Business District with condition of publication held until funds are paid in full.

Did You Know...

...that in May 1894 Carver Resident Anton Knoblauch advertised in the Weekly Valley Herald that his Bank of Carver "had $200,000 IN Eastern Money loaner cash available to loan for five years at seven percent annually on improved farms."

Highway #212 Design Build Update

MNDot is finalizing the grading, drainage and surfacing plan set for the Highway #212 Design Build Project in the Carver area. Work is still being done on final signage, striping plans and municipal utilities in the area. Concern has been voiced on the name proposed for County Road #11. Additional cost may be involved due to the length of the name. Suggestion was made to make inquiries with the county.

The city engineer interjected proposed box culvert for pedestrian crossing of the county road. This proposal was not included in the original plans for the design built contract or preliminary concepts. This issue should be presented to the Park and Recreation Board for their discussion and recommendations.

Engaged?

DID YOU JUST GET ENGAGED AND DON'T KNOW WHERE TO BEGIN?

Don't worry, Charlotte Sandeen with Lotties Invitations and Bridal Accessories can help you out! Looking for ideas on where to get married, who can marry you or were to hold your wedding reception, she can help. She can also help you out with your wedding invitations and any accessories that you may need for your wedding such as cake toppers, serving sets, ring bearer pillow, unity candles, toasting flutes, bridal party gifts and much more. You can call Charlotte Sandeen at 952-457-9540 or she can be reached at lotties13@hotmail.com. Check out her website at www.lottiesbridal.com

East Union Spring Carnival

The East Union school has sent word that they are very busy & excited to present to the community their Spring Carnival scheduled, February 24th, Friday from 5 PM to 8 PM. New games, along with the old reliables have been added. Cotton candy, pop, popcorn and subway sandwiches will all be offered for the eateries. There will also be a silent auction.

They've also requested help. Volunteers are needed, along with donations for the silent auction or classroom theme baskets. The word has it that "talents and time are precious things to give and receive". (If you call the East Union staff they'll be happy to direct you to the PTO individual to take your questions, help and donations at 952) 556-6800.)

They also sent word too of the need for 'kisses' Think their intent is the concrete kind, not the abstract. We're talking Hershey kisses. You knew that didn't you?

Did you know that the East Union students participated in an important service project program called "Pennies for Patient"? These pennies are donated for the patients afflicted with blood related cancers. Maybe you too could take a moment to think about these patients daily, say a prayer and a remind ourselves just how lucky we are. Good Job Kids!

Carver Fire Department Highlights and Community Calendar

February 2006

February 9th - Happy Birthday Brenna!
February 15th - Happy Birthday Kim!
Happy Birthday Katie!
Happy Anniversary Dwight and Janet!
February 18th - Happy Birthday Merva!
February 22nd - Happy Birthday Sandra!
Heritage Preservation Commission Meeting
February 23rd - Fire Department Meeting Night
February 24th - East Union School Carnival (5 PM – 8 PM)
February 27th - Happy Birthday Glen!
Comprehensive Plan Work Group Meeting
February 28th - Planning Commission Meeting

March 2006

March 1st - Ash Wednesday
March 2nd - East Union National Theater for Children Program 10 AM
Drill Night
Happy Birthday Cindy!
Happy Birthday Sonny!
March 3rd - No School – Teacher WorkShop
March 5th - Happy Birthday Karen!
March 6th - Council Meeting
March 6th through 10th - Mid-Winter Break
No School
March 7th - Carver's Women's Business Group Meeting
March 10th - Happy Birthday Sandy!
March 13th - Park and Recreation Board Meeting
Happy Birthday Andrea!
March 14th - Dahlgren Township Board Annual Meeting
Elections
March 17th - St Patrick's Day
March 19fh - Carver Lion's Pancake Breakfast
7:30 AM – 1 PM
March 20th - First Day of Spring
Council Meeting
Drill Night
March 21st - Heritage Preservation Commission Meeting
March 24th - Happy Birthday Keith!
March 25th - Happy Birthday Bette!
March 26th - Happy Birthday James!
Happy Birthday Beth!
March27th - Comprehensive Plan Work Group Meeting
March 28th - Planning Commission Meeting
March 30th - Fire Department Meeting Night
Happy Birthday Paul!
March 31st - Work Shop Day

Disclaimer

The 'unapproved' minutes of the council and the township have been referenced for the purposes of reporting news in the "*Villager Tower*" and creating the contents of this newsletter for the purpose of informing residents in the City of Carver and the townships surrounding the city.

Did You Know...

...that in late 1867 hotel proprietor Charles A Blomquist installed a billiard hall in the basement of his recently purchased Carver House Hotel, which once sat on the present-day site of Carver's Gazebo Park.

Carver Youth Baseball/Softball Youth Association

Again, it is the time of the year to be planning for Softball and Baseball next summer. Boy's we are working at getting our teams back in Carver Watch for further updates and please contact Jane or call the City Hall and let them know you are interested in helping with this project.

Girls and T-Ball players - Information and registration's will be out between the 25th of Jan and Feb 15th.

The association is still looking for volunteers to help Jane Thon organize the Boy's Baseball league for the 2006. One responsibility of this volunteer or volunteers would be contacting the Athletic Director (Jordan, Norwood-Young America, Waconia, etc) from our neighboring towns to inquire if the Carver's Baseball team could join their league. For additional information, please contact City Hall or attend the next Park and Recreation Board meeting. These meetings are held at the Fire Station/Public Works Facility. Remember, the sooner we all start working on this project the better chance of playing ball. Come on folks, give the city or Jane a call now. Your help and expertise are needed.

Carver Lions

Ready for breakfast? Well not quite huh? Mark your calendars! On Sunday, March 19th at the Village Hall, the Carver Lions will be hosting the Pancake Breakfast. Listen closely. Diabetes screening will be offered (again) at no charge. Now, remember, for the best results and an accurate reading from the screening, you must fast, at least ten hours prior to the screening. The proceeds for this event will be put towards the Lions community projects. Before we forget to tell you, also, a drop off box will be available that morning for you to bring any and all those obsolete, unusable prescription eyeglasses for their Sight Program. You also need to know that if you buy a ticket in advance for $6, this will only make you eligible for the Savings Bond Drawing at the breakfast. Grab the kids, under six years old get to eat free, those youngsters from six to twelve years of age will only cost you two bucks a piece. Now where can you feed the whole crew that efficiently? At home, I know. Treat everyone and socialize, enjoy no mess, no bother and wonderful company to boot. The lady of the house will appreciate the effort. If 7:30 AM is too early, you can go a little later, up until 1 PM other wise you miss boarding the boat. See ya' there now, at the Village Hall on March 19th, between 7:30 AM and 1 PM for breakfast. Okay? Okay!

Now that y'all have had breakfast. Let's talk about the dinner menu. Yea, yea, I know, there is a month and a half difference between these two meals. Humor me. Follow along with my train of thought here. On April 28th, the Lions have scheduled their Pork Chop Dinner. Let's see that's a Friday night. More details will follow. Mark your calendars.

In case you've forgotten, (yea right) the Lions meet the first and third Wednesday of the month at the Village Hall. Come and check it out. It just might be worth your time.

Heritage Development

The City Planner presented to the council a concept plan submitted by Centex Homes for the Heritage Development. The development involved the north part of the property previously owned. Feedback was requested from the city regarding moving forward with the submitted plans proposed to be identified as Glen at Spring Creek. Question was asked concerning the label of Commercial/High Density and the affect on the Comprehensive Plan. There was no expectations of this affecting the Comprehensive Plan. A slide presentation of the new concept plan was presented to the council.

The city engineer submitted his input in writing on the issue. Clarification was requested concerning these submissions involving a second access to the property, a cul-de-sac, additional parking or visitors parking, as well as drainage and storm water issues. Question was also submitted regarding affordable housing. The developer's response was that several proposed units were considered as affordable.

Congratulations!!!

Andy and Mary Williamson presented the world with their daughter, Grace on January 31st. Congratulations Andy and Mary!

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